

Possible restrictions on broadband total absorption in the 2d limit through sum rules

The focus of these notes is to determine if sum rules put a restriction on the bandwidth of perfect CPA for a monolayer system. We know that

$$\varepsilon(\omega) = 1 + \chi(\omega) = 1 + \frac{i\sigma(\omega)}{\omega\varepsilon_0} \rightarrow \sigma(\omega) = -i\omega\varepsilon_0\chi(\omega)$$

From this, we obtain: $\Re\sigma(\omega) = \omega\varepsilon_0\Im\chi(\omega)$, $\Im\sigma(\omega) = -\omega\varepsilon_0\Re\chi(\omega)$

Using the sum rule, https://hackmd.io/@aligho/Bkk_HLUwlg

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$$\Re\chi(\omega) = \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^\infty \frac{\omega' \Im\chi(\omega')}{\omega'^2 - \omega^2} d\omega'$$

We obtain (setting $\sigma(\omega) = \sigma'(\omega) + i\sigma''(\omega)$):

$$\lim_{\omega \rightarrow \infty} \omega\sigma''(\omega) = \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^\infty \sigma'(\omega') d\omega'$$

If we assume that $\sigma''(\omega) \approx ne^2/m\omega$ at high frequencies (and use the CPA condition for double-sided illumination of a monolayer, $\sigma(\omega) = 2c\varepsilon_0$), we have that:

$$\frac{\pi ne^2}{2m} > 2c\varepsilon_0(\Delta_\omega) \rightarrow \frac{\pi ne^2}{4mc\varepsilon_0} = \left(\frac{e^2}{4\pi\varepsilon_0\hbar c} \right) \frac{\pi^2 n\hbar}{m} = \alpha\pi^2 n\hbar/m > \Delta_\omega$$

Therefore, the bound is linear in the electronic density. We estimate this:

$$\frac{\pi^2}{137} \frac{n}{0.5 \times 10^6 \text{ eV}} (9 \times 10^{20} \text{ cm}^2) (6.67 \times 10^{-16} \text{ eV}) \times 10^{-12} \text{ THz} \approx$$

$$(0.072)(18n) \times 10^{-14} \text{ cm}^2 \text{ THz} = 1.3n \times 10^{-14} \text{ cm}^2 \text{ THz}$$

Therefore, for a reasonable electron density, we can have broadband CPA over a band of at most a few terahertz.

